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University of the People

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Unit 1 Assignment

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Adjusting to the Online Learning Community

In the online developer communities where I usually hang out to work on coding projects, communication is pretty fast-paced and casual. It is mostly about finding quick solutions to problems. Moving into the University of the People learning community means I need to make a real shift in how I communicate. As Baldwin et al. (2020) point out, college can be a bit uncomfortable at first because it challenges our usual habits. For me, the biggest adjustment is stepping back from that rapid-fire chat style and learning how to engage in deeper, more thoughtful academic discussions. I plan to adapt by just slowing down—taking the time to properly draft my posts, actually reading my classmates' perspectives, and focusing on the whole topic instead of just looking for a quick fix.

The main difference between a regular social forum and our online learning space is the goal behind the conversation. Social communities are usually about entertainment or quick answers, while this academic space is all about structured learning, integrity, and respect. Since almost all of our communication here is text-based, sticking to netiquette is extremely important so things are not misunderstood.

Looking at the rules, one that really stands out for me is using a Proper Writing Style. On sites like Reddit or Discord, using slang and abbreviations is no big deal, but here, taking the time to write clearly with good grammar shows respect for my classmates' time. Another rule from the reading that I think is great is "Share Expert Knowledge." We all come from different

educational and cultural backgrounds. By sharing helpful resources or just a different perspective, we can really help each other out and build a better learning environment.

References

Baldwin, A., August, L., Bennett, J., Mathues, S., Monroe, S., O'Leary, M. J., Pearson, A., Troesh, J., & Watts, M. (2020). *College success*. OpenStax. <https://openstax.org/details/books/college-success>